

He and I

we live life
well, he
i am not so sure
at two very
different cadences
he would know
where to start—
i
not so sure because
adventure awaits me
there is
a philosophy
a structure
a way of life
that he and I
simply don't agree
i am his product
his face
his name
just the second version
he expected us to share
his life
his route
but a reminder
the second version
takes different
direction
i embrace possibility
with stories
and finding lives
behind faces
he surrounds himself
with foes, though
no war declared
simply reading threats from
empty faces
we argue most
when my mother's
name arises

her name holds
weight

he believes her weight
keeps me down
limits me from
reaching the sky
the ways in which
she holds me back

i believe her weight
keeps me grounded
the reason my
feet know earth
and i never
floated away
always there
to hold me up

burden and value
we have always been
misaligned

he consumes himself
with the green bill
the only goal
is to have
more

i find wealth in
my support system
i have invested in

i make room for

extra chairs
at the table

he would never

let in the unknown

i marinate

in phone calls
that should have ended
thirty minutes ago

he would never

go off schedule
and it's the

little things
as to why

he searches for happiness
like a destination
like a place he will
eventually arrive

but happiness is not
a box to check
off the bucket list

i found happiness
in the freedom
of inside jokes
to wander
to change my mind
to lose the map
but to have friends
who ask
"made it home?"

that is how
we find our way

he would never
understand

he has tunnel vision
for success
with no clear end his
eyes remain fixed
no periphery
not for anything
not for anyone
not even for—

i
see him
accompanied with
success
a companion not
capable of pulling
up a chair
or caring
if he made it
home safe